# Riley McDanal, M.A.

Clinical Psychological Science PhD Candidate
NSF GRFP Fellow
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## EDUCATION

**Stony Brook University** — Stony Brook, NY
*(anticipated 2026)* Ph.D. in Clinical Psychology — 2020 – current
*(dissertation successfully defended 12/2025)*

**Stony Brook University** — Stony Brook, NY
M.A. in Psychology — 2020 – 2022

**University of California, Berkeley** — Berkeley, CA
B.A. in Psychology — 2016 – 2019

## FELLOWSHIPS AND GRANTS

**National Science Foundation Graduate Research Fellowship Program** (NSF GRFP) — 2022 – 2027
Stony Brook University. PI. Total amount awarded: $152,000.

**Academy of Psychological Clinical Science Dissertation Award** — 2025
Stony Brook University. PI. Amount awarded: $2,000.

**APF Council of Graduate Departments of Psychology Graduate Student Scholarship** — 2025
Stony Brook University. PI. Amount awarded: $2,000.

**Graduate Research Empowering and Accelerating Talent Award** (GREAT Award) — 2023
Stony Brook University. PI. Amount awarded: $5,000.

**John Neale Endowed Graduate Student Excellence Fund** — 2021
Stony Brook University. PI. Amount awarded: $750.

***(declined)* Cunningham Fellowship** — 2020 – 2024
Virginia Tech. Total amount offered: $97,392.

## HONORS AND AWARDS

**Society for Research in Psychopathology EDI Scholarship** — 2022 – 2023
Stony Brook University.

**LifeData Award** — 2020
Stony Brook University.

**Distinction in General Scholarship** — 2019
University of California, Berkeley.

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

Scalable mental healthcare; identity, marginalization, and health; relational context and interpersonal processes; psychiatry nosology; measurement and assessment; open science practices.

## PUBLICATIONS

*Citations: 398 / H-index: 10 (As of 03.09.2026)*

*First-author citations: 122 / First-author H-index: 4*

( * Indicates student/trainee; † Indicates equal co-authorship )

### PEER-REVIEWED JOURNAL ARTICLES

11. Pigart, C. J., Cohen, K. A., **McDanal, R.**, Schleider, J. L., & Cooper, K. M. (in press). STEM, gender, and mental health: Understanding depression and anxiety in a national undergraduate sample. *PLOS Mental Health, 2*(8), e0000364.

10. Dodge, K. A., Prinstein, M. J., Evans, A. C., Ahuvia, I. L., Alvarez, K., Beidas, R. S., Brown, A. J., Cuijpers, P., Denton, E., Hoagwood, K. E., Johnson, C., Kazdin, A. E., **McDanal, R.**, Metzger, I. W., Rowley, S. N., Schleider, J. L., Shaw, D. S. (2024). Population mental health science: Guiding principles and initial agenda. *American Psychologist, 79*(6), 805.

9. **McDanal, R.**, Shen, J., Fox, K. R., Eaton, N. R., & Schleider, J. L. (2024). Predicting transdiagnostic symptom change across diverse demographic groups in single-session interventions for adolescent depression. *Clinical Psychological Science, 12*(6), 1056-1074.

8. Deisenhofer, A-K., Barkham, M., Beierl, E. T., Schwartz, B., Aafjes-van Doorn, K., … Cohen, Z. (50 other coauthors, incl. **McDanal, R.**) (2023). Implementing precision methods in personalizing psychological therapies: Barriers and possible ways forward. *Behaviour Research and Therapy, 172,* 104443.

7. Ghosh, A., Cohen, K., Jans, L., Busch, C., **McDanal, R.**, Yang, Y., Cooper, K., & Schleider, J. L. (2023). A digital single-session intervention (Project Engage) to address fear of negative evaluation among college students: A pilot randomized controlled trial. *JMIR Mental Health, 10,* e48926.

6. Shen, J., Rubin, A., Cohen, K., Hart, E. A., Sung, J., **McDanal, R.**, Roulston, C., Sotomayor, I., Fox. K. R., & Schleider, J. L. (2023). Randomized evaluation of an online single-session intervention for minority stress in LGBTQ+ adolescents. *Internet Interventions, 33*, 100633.

5. **McDanal, R.**, Schleider, J. L., Fox, K. R., & Eaton, N. R. (2023). Loneliness in gender- and sexual orientation-diverse adolescents: Measurement invariance analyses and between-group comparisons. *Assessment, 30*(3), 706–727.

4. **McDanal, R.**, Parisi, D., Opara, I.†, & Schleider, J. L.† (2022). Effects of brief interventions on internalizing symptoms and substance use in youth: A systematic review. *Clinical Child and Family Psychology Review, 25*, 339-355.

3. **McDanal, R.**, Rubin, A., Fox, K. R., & Schleider, J. L. (2022). Associations of LGBTQ+ identities with acceptability and efficacy of online single-session youth mental health interventions. *Behavior Therapy, 53*, 376-391.

2. Inman, E. M., Bermejo, R. M., **McDanal, R.**, Nelson, B., Richmond, R. L., Schleider, J. L., & London, B. (2021). Discrimination and psychosocial engagement during the COVID-19 pandemic. *Stigma and Health, 6*, 380-383.

1. Stanton, K., Brown, M. F. D., **McDanal, R.**, Carlton, C. N., & Emery, N. N. (2021). Informing the classification and assessment of positive emotional experiences: A multisample examination of hierarchical positive emotionality models. *Psychological Assessment, 33*(11), 1038-1049.

## CHAPTERS

2. **McDanal, R.** & Schleider, J. L. (2023). Investing in novel intervention delivery systems. *Population health science summit: Grounding evidence and preliminary research synthesis.* American Psychological Association.

1. Ghosh, A., **McDanal, R.**, & Schleider, J. L. (2023). Digital single-session interventions for child and adolescent mental health: Evidence and potential for dissemination across low- and middle-income countries. *Advances in Psychiatry and Behavioral Health.* Elsevier.

## MANUSCRIPTS UNDER REVIEW

4. * Ortells-Faci, P., McDanal, R., Zhang, Y., Klein, D. N., Nelson, B. D., Kotov, R., & Eaton, N. R. (under review). Reciprocal relations between peer victimization, rumination, and dysphoria: A multi-wave longitudinal study of adolescent girls. *OSF Preprints.*

3. Lynam, D. R., Sbarra, D. A., Tackett, J. L., Lui, P. P., **McDanal, R.**, Schaumberg, K., Wright, A. G. C., Yang, Y., & Miller, J. D. (under review). The open science movement and clinical psychology training: Rigorous science is transparent science. *OSF Preprints.*

2. * Ortells Faci, P.[†], **McDanal, R.**[†], & Eaton, N. R. (under review). Loneliness in sexual and gender minority youths: Critical implications of a multidimensional approach. *OSF Preprints.*

1. Roos, C. R., McHugh, R. K., Vafaie, N., Schleider, J. L., **McDanal, R.**, DeBenedictis, A., Palmer, R., John, M., Votaw, V. R., & Kober, H. (under review). Pilot randomized trial of Visitor Mindset: A single-session web-based intervention targeting emotion-related beliefs and emotion regulation skills.

## POPULAR PRESS PUBLICATIONS

2. **McDanal, R.** (2023). Marginalized populations deserve our very best: Measurement invariance as the foundation of mental health disparities research. *PCSAS Newsletter.*

1. **McDanal, R.** (2021). Integrating single-session intervention approaches into clinical training programs. *PCSAS Newsletter.*

# PRESENTATIONS

( * Indicates student/trainee; † Indicates equal co-authorship )

## TALKS

* Ortells Faci, P., **McDanal, R.**, Yao, A., Burger, J., Gabrielli, J. T., & Eaton, N. R. (2026, February). *Impulsive behavior and emotional distress in the daily lives of sexual and gender minority adults.* Eastern Psychological Association Annual Meeting, Boston, MA.

**McDanal, R.**, Kim, H., Schleider, J. L., & Eaton, N. R. (2025, September). *Transdiagnostic single-session intervention effects on adolescent demoralization: A piecewise multilevel analysis of change patterns in a randomized controlled trial.* Society for Research in Psychopathology Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA.

**McDanal, R.**, Schleider, J. L., Shen, J., Fox, K. R., & Eaton, N. R. (2025, March). *Single-session online interventions drive transdiagnostic change across initial symptom severity levels: Implications for stepped care.* Annual Meeting of the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology Consortium, Denver, CO.

* Ortells-Faci, P., **McDanal, R.**, Zhang, Y., Eaton, N. R., & Kotov, R. (2025, March). *Distinguishing between-person and within-person stability in the longitudinal relationship of victimization and dysphoria in adolescent girls.* Annual Meeting of the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology Consortium, Denver, CO.

**McDanal, R.**, Schleider, J. L., & Eaton, N. R. (2024, March). *The meta-structure of loneliness as different dimensions of varying resolution: Links with transdiagnostic psychopathology and disparities across populations.* Annual Meeting of the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology Consortium, San Diego, CA.

**McDanal, R.**, Shen, J., Fox, K. R., Schleider, J. L., & Eaton, N. R. (2022, May). *Single-session interventions reduced transdiagnostic internalizing symptoms in adolescents with diverse identities during the COVID-19 pandemic.* Annual Meeting of the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology Consortium, virtual.

## SYMPOSIA

Rubin, A., Shen, J., **McDanal, R.**, Schleider, J. L., & Fox, K. R. (2022, November). *Exploring the need for single-session interventions that improve NSSI/SI outcomes in LGBTQ+ youths.* Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies 56th Annual Convention, New York, NY. **[Presented by McDanal, R.]**

## POSTERS

* Ortells-Faci, P., **McDanal, R.**, Zhang, Y., Klein, D. N., Nelson, B. D., Kotov R., & Eaton, N. R. (2025, September). *Do symptoms or stressors come first? Interrelations and stability of rumination, victimization and internalizing problems among adolescent girls.* Society for Research in Psychopathology Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA.

Grieshaber, A., Calentino, A., Harrison, M. S., **McDanal, R.**, & Klein, D. N. (2025, September). *Early childhood predictors of depression course.* Society for Research in Psychopathology Annual Meeting, Los Angeles, CA.

* Murata, M., Smith, A. C., & **McDanal, R.** (2025, June). *Where do differences in single-session intervention effectiveness emerge? A multilevel analysis of a body neutrality intervention for sexual and gender minority youth.* 5th International Single Session Therapies Symposium, Chicago, IL.

* Ortells-Faci, P., **McDanal, R.**, & Eaton, N. R. (2025, May). *Unpacking the dimensions of loneliness: Links to transdiagnostic internalizing disparities in sexual and gender minority youth.* Association of Psychological Science Conference, Washington, DC.

**McDanal, R.** Schleider, J. L., Shen, J., Fox, K. R., & Eaton, N. R. (2025, March). *Single-session online interventions drive transdiagnostic change across initial symptom severity levels: Implications for stepped care.* Annual Meeting of the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology Consortium, Denver, CO.

* Ortells-Faci, P., **McDanal, R.**, Zhang, Y., & Eaton, N. R. (2025, March). *Distinguishing between-person and within-person stability in the longitudinal relationship of victimization and dysphoria in adolescent girls.* Annual Meeting of the Hierarchical Taxonomy of Psychopathology Consortium, Denver, CO.

**McDanal, R.**, Parisi, D., Opara, I.[†], & Schleider, J. L.[†] (2022, November). *Effects of brief interventions on internalizing symptoms and substance use in youth: A systematic review.* Clinical Psychological Science Special Interest Group Exposition in the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies 56th Annual Convention, New York, NY.

**McDanal, R.**, Shen, J., Fox, K. R., Schleider, J. L., & Eaton, N. R. (2022, September). *Transdiagnostic symptom change across diverse demographic groups in an RCT of single-session interventions for adolescent depression.* Society for Research in Psychopathology Annual Meeting, Philadelphia, PA.

**McDanal, R.**, Rubin, A., Fox, K. R., & Schleider, J. L. (2021, November). *Associations of LGBTQ+ identities with acceptability and efficacy of online single-session youth mental health interventions.* Oppression & Resilience Special Interest Group Exposition in the Association for Behavioral and Cognitive Therapies Virtual Convention, virtual.

**McDanal, R.**, Shen, J., Fox, K. R., Eaton, N. R., & Schleider, J. L. (2021, September). *Predicting transdiagnostic symptom change in a randomized trial of single-session interventions for adolescent depression.* Treatment Selection Idea Lab Virtual Convention, virtual.

Inman, E. M., Bermejo, R., **McDanal, R.**, Nelson, B., Richmond, R., Schleider, J. L., & London, B. (2021, February). *Identity models of discrimination and psychosocial engagement during the COVID-19 pandemic.* Society for Personality and Social Psychology Virtual Convention, virtual.

## LAB AFFILIATIONS

**SPECTRUM LAB**, Stony Brook University — Dir: Nicholas Eaton, PhD

**PhD Student** — 2020 – current

Transdiagnostic psychopathology and mental health disparities.

**LAB FOR SCALABLE MENTAL HEALTH**, Northwestern University Dir: Jessica Schleider, PhD
**PhD Student** 2020 – current
Digital intervention and health equity.

**IDIOGRAPHIC DYNAMICS LAB**, UC Berkeley Dir: Aaron Fisher, PhD
**Postbac Research Assistant** 2019 – 2020
Experience sampling of psychopathology and behavior.

**BERKELEY SOCIAL INTERACTION LAB**, UC Berkeley Dir: Dacher Keltner, PhD
**Undergraduate and Postbac Research Assistant** 2017 – 2020
Sociocultural psychology and individual emotional experience.

## REVIEWING

*Journal of Gay and Lesbian Mental Health (2025)*
*Assessment (2025)*
*BMC Psychology (2025)*
*JMIR Mental Health (2025)*
*BMC Public Health (2025)*
*Journal of Homosexuality (2025)*
*Child Psychiatry & Human Development (2024)*
*Collabra: Psychology (2023)*
*JAMA Network Open (2022)*

## TEACHING

### INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD – *independently designed course*

**Psychopathology Classification**, Stony Brook University Summer 2022 / 23 / 24 / 25; Winter 2023 / 24 / 25

Novel special topics course on the history, methodology, and clinical utility of different approaches to conceptualizing the nature of psychopathology (DSM/ICD; RDoC; HiTOP; Network Analysis).

- Total students: 193 | Average course rating: 4.9/5.0

### INSTRUCTOR OF RECORD

**Introduction to Psychology**, Stony Brook University Winter 2022

Introductory general psychology course. Topics included biological, cognitive, personality, developmental, social, and clinical psychology; research methods; ethics.

- Total students: 28 | Average course rating: 5.0/5.0

### GUEST LECTURER

**Reading in Psychology: Professional Development**, Stony Brook University Fall 2023 / 24

Presentation on writing a compelling application statement for admission to graduate programs in psychology. Supported students in drafting an outline; facilitated small group discussions about their ideas.

**Evidence-Based Practice Course**, Mercer University Fall 2022

Presentation on Stony Brook's Single-Session Consultation program. Demonstrated implementation and facilitated student practice.

### RECITATION INSTRUCTOR

**Research and Writing in Psychology**, Stony Brook University Spring 2022

Course on the research process in psychology. Guided students through conceptualizing their own research question, methodology, and analytic approach; taught students how to draft a mock empirical manuscript.

### TEACHING ASSISTANT

**Health Psychology**, Stony Brook University Fall 2021

**Survey in Abnormal and Clinical Psychology**, Stony Brook University Fall 2020

## CLINICAL

### Areas of specialization

Emotion dysregulation, experiential avoidance, low self-esteem, interpersonal/marital/family problems

### Primary modalities

Cognitive Behavioral Therapy (CBT); Dialectical Behavior Therapy (DBT); Acceptance and Commitment Therapy (ACT); Integrative Behavioral Couple Therapy (IBCT); Emotionally Focused Family Therapy (EFFT)

### Positions

**Krasner Psychological Center**, Stony Brook, NY. 2021 – 2023; 2025 – current
Roles: Therapist; Intern; Evaluator; Peer supervisor
Responsibilities: Individual, group, and couples therapy; Assessment; Peer supervision

**Stony Brook University Hospital, Child Inpatient Psychiatry Unit**, Stony Brook, NY. 2025 – current
Role: Intern
Responsibilities: Individual and group therapy

**Mind-Body Clinical Research Center**, Stony Brook, NY. 2025 – current
Role: Intern
Responsibilities: Individual and group therapy

**Center for Cognitive & Dialectical Behavior Therapy**, Lake Success, NY. 2023 – 2024
Role: Extern
Responsibilities: Individual, group, couples, and family therapy

**Single Session Support Clinic, Stony Brook University**, Stony Brook, NY. 2023
Role: Provider
Responsibilities: Individual consultation sessions

## Competencies

**Individual Therapy**

- Provide individual therapy using CBT, DBT, and ACT for adults, adolescents, children, and parents.
- Integrate multiple therapeutic modalities based on client presentation and treatment setting.
- Use data from recurring standardized and personalized questionnaires to guide treatment planning.
- Conduct crisis intervention, safety planning, suicide risk assessment, and victimization risk assessment.
- Offer phone coaching and after-hours crisis management for clients with chronic emotion dysregulation.
- Implement inpatient psychiatric crisis stabilization and discharge planning.
- Organize collaborative care with multidisciplinary teams (psychiatrists, social workers, nurses).
- Deliver single-session consultations with solution-focused brief interventions.

**Group Therapy**

- Lead DBT skills groups for adults, children, and families in outpatient and inpatient settings.
- Teach core DBT modules and conduct skill review sessions.

**Couples/Family Therapy**

- Provide IBCT and EFFT for couples and families.
- Implement communication training, conflict resolution, and systemic interventions.

**Psychological Assessment**

- Conduct comprehensive evaluations using cognitive, achievement, and executive functioning batteries.
- Administer structured diagnostic interviews and other measures as clinically indicated.
- Generate integrated reports and provide individualized feedback to clients.

**Intake Coordination and Training**

- Perform therapy intake assessments, risk screening, and diagnostic interviews.
- Train and supervise new staff in screening procedures.

**Peer Supervision**

- Supervise practicum students in the provision of CBT for anxiety in young adulthood.
- Meet weekly to discuss case conceptualization, treatment planning, and intervention implementation.

# MENTORSHIP

## Research mentor

Pau Ortells Faci (2024 – current) — Spectrum Lab *(Lab Director: Dr. Nicholas Eaton)*

- Trained mentee in study design and analysis.
    - Reciprocal relations between peer victimization, rumination, and dysphoria: A multi-wave longitudinal study of adolescent girls. *Preprint*.
    - Loneliness in sexual and gender minority youths: Critical implications of a multidimensional approach. *Preprint*.
    - The interplay of negative urgency and internalizing distress in the daily lives of sexual and gender minorities exposed to discrimination. *Upcoming oral presentation.*

- Distinguishing between-person and within-person stability in the longitudinal relationship of victimization and dysphoria in adolescent girls. *Flash talk and poster presentation.*
- Do symptoms or stressors come first? Interrelations and stability of rumination, victimization and internalizing problems among adolescent girls. *Poster presentation.*
- Unpacking the dimensions of loneliness: Links to transdiagnostic internalizing disparities in sexual and gender minority youth. *Poster presentation.*
- Temporal dynamics between peer victimization and internalizing problems in sexual and gender minoritized youth: A random intercept cross-lagged panel model. *Preregistration*.

Mia Murata (2024 – 2025) — Lab for Scalable Mental Health *(Lab Director: Dr. Jessica Schleider)*

- Trained mentee in study design and analysis.
  - Where do differences in single-session intervention effectiveness emerge? A multilevel analysis of a body neutrality intervention for sexual and gender minority youth. *Poster presentation.*

Hein Kim (2024 – 2025) — Lab for Scalable Mental Health *(Lab Director: Dr. Jessica Schleider)*

- Trained mentee in intervention development.

Aijia Yao (2021 – 2023) — Lab for Scalable Mental Health *(Lab Director: Dr. Jessica Schleider)*

- Trained mentee in experience sampling data collection.

### Peer mentor

Victoria Sarita (2021 – 2022) — Lab for Scalable Mental Health *(Lab Director: Dr. Jessica Schleider)*
Lucy Gordon (2021 – 2022) — Lab for Scalable Mental Health *(Lab Director: Dr. Jessica Schleider)*
Colleen McGuckin (2020 – 2021) — Women in Science and Engineering at Stony Brook University

## COMMUNITY

***Academy Open Science Committee (OSC)***
*Committee Member (2025 – current)*
Assists programs with developing open science practices; works to improve transparency in clinical science.

***Undergraduate Mentoring Committee***
*Committee Member (2022 – current)*
Contributes to outreach, workshops, and resources for undergraduate students at Stony Brook University.

***Long Island Science & Engineering Fair***
*Volunteer Judge (2025)*
Served as a judge of high school science fair projects in the Behavioral and Social Sciences category.

***Psychological Clinical Science Accreditation System (PCSAS)***
*Representative (2021 – 2023)*
Acted as a liaison between PCSAS and Stony Brook and wrote articles for the PCSAS newsletter.

***Women in Science and Engineering (WISE)***
*Mentor (2020 – 2021)*
Mentored an undergraduate student in the WISE program.

***Dismantling Systemic Shortcomings in Education and Clinical Training (DiSSECT)***
*Supporting Evidence Team Member (2019 – 2020)*
Compiled evidence supporting actionable anti-racist changes in education and clinical training programs.

***Psychology and Cognitive Sciences Undergraduate Lab at Berkeley***
*Co-Founder and Manager (2017), Director (2018), Advisor (2019)*
Taught research skills to undergraduates through workshops and advising; supervised undergraduate project groups investigating various topics in psychology and cognitive science.

***Undergraduate Journal of Psychology at Berkeley***
*Executive Director (2017 – 2018), Editor-in-Chief (2018 – 2019)*
Led process of undergraduate manuscript selection, editing, and publication.

## PROFESSIONAL

***Consultant*, American Psychological Association**, virtual. 2022 – 2023
Developed a research summary on delivery systems for intervention administration and single touch-point services. Included in an APA response to a Request for Information (RFI) on innovative approaches to prevent mental health problems and promote mental wellness in populations that experience health disparities.

***Author*, Supportiv**, virtual. 2019 – 2021
Wrote empirically informed mental health articles for dissemination to the public.

## SKILLS

R, Mplus, SPSS, Qualtrics, quantitative modeling, intervention development, Spanish proficiency

*Last updated 03.09.2026*